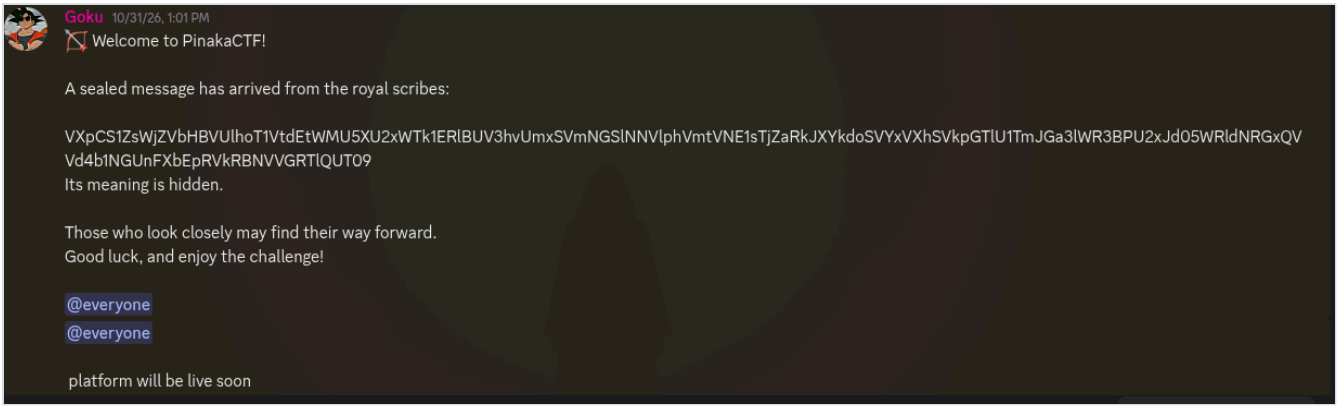
MISC - Welcome to PINAKA

Flag: `PinakaCTF{cur10517y_unl0ck5_7h3_g473}`

The welcome message on Discord came with a "sealed message from the royal scribes" and the line "Its meaning is hidden. Those who look closely may find their way forward."

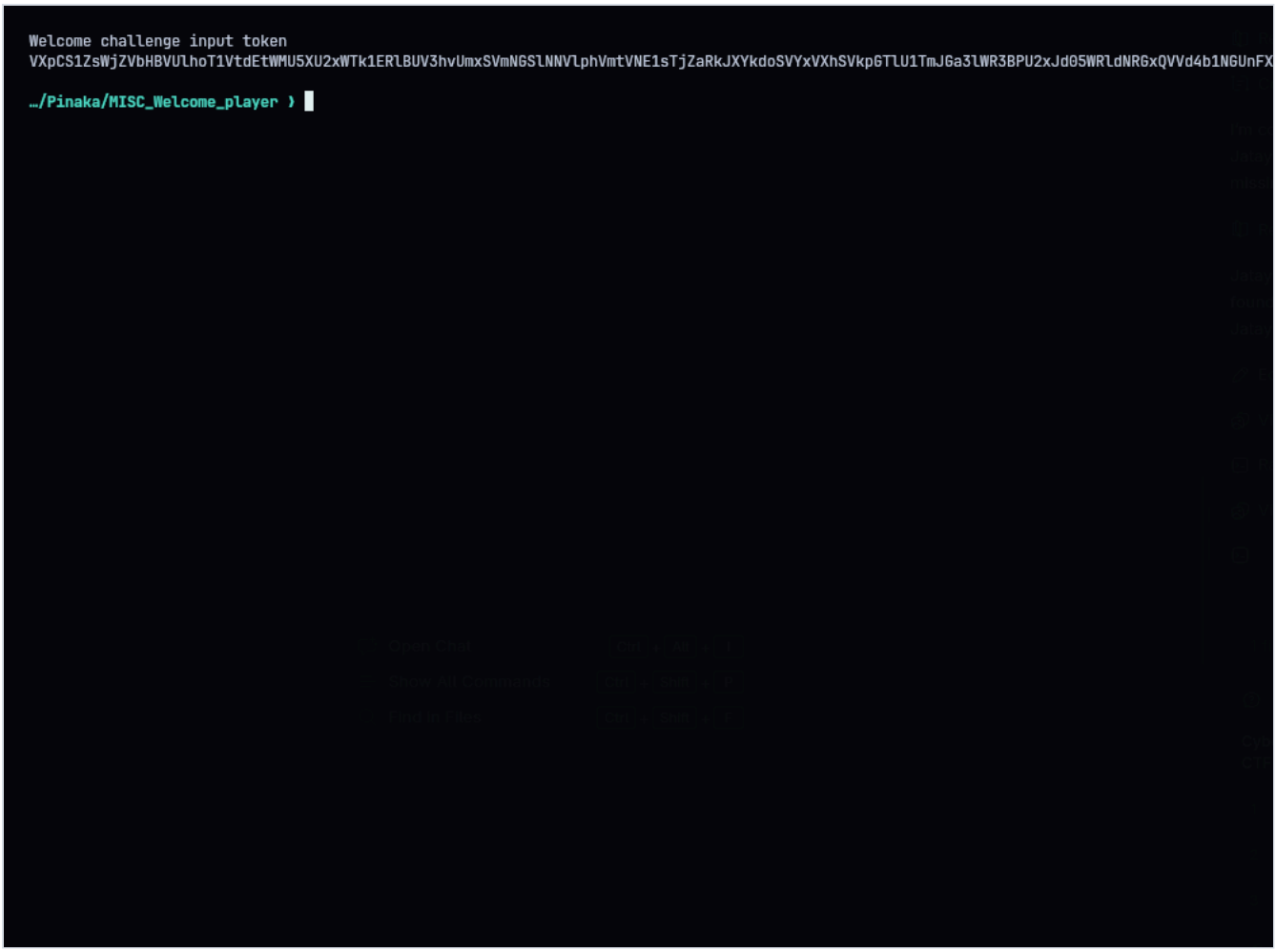


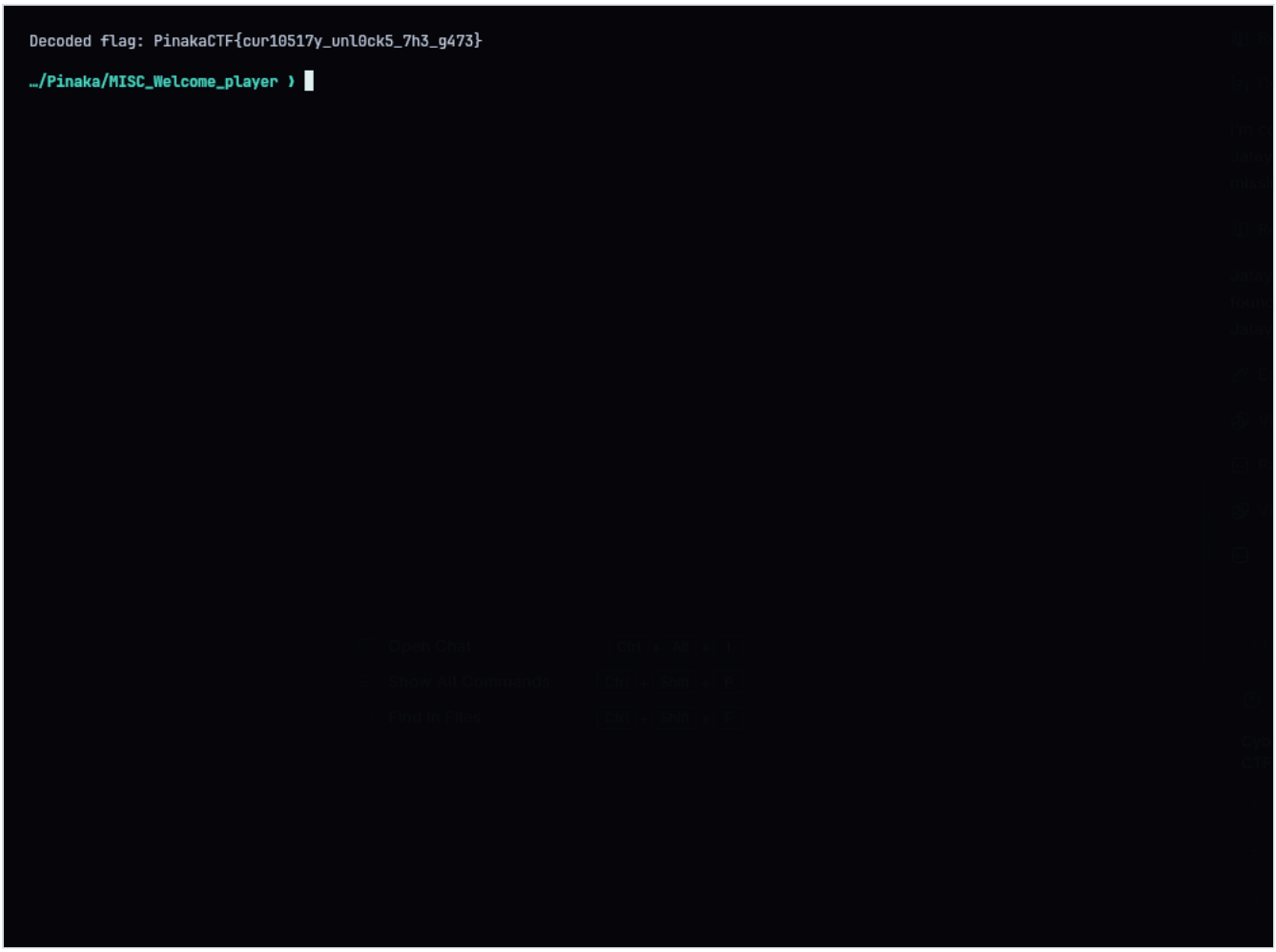
The string only uses the Base64 alphabet, and decoding it gives another Base64-looking string (starting `UzBK...`), so it's Base64 inside Base64. Peeling it:

Step	Output
Base64	`UzBKVlZ6UlpURXhOUmtKV1NWSlVNMDFPTWxoRlRVcFJSMVZa...`
Base64	`S0JVVzRZTExNRkJWSVJUM01OMlhFTUpRR1VZVE82SzdPVlhH...`
Base64	`KBUW4YLLMFBVIRT3MN2XEMJQGUYTO6K7OVXGYMDDNM2V6N3IGNPWONBXGN6Q====`
Base32	`PinakaCTF{cur10517y_unl0ck5_7h3_g473}`

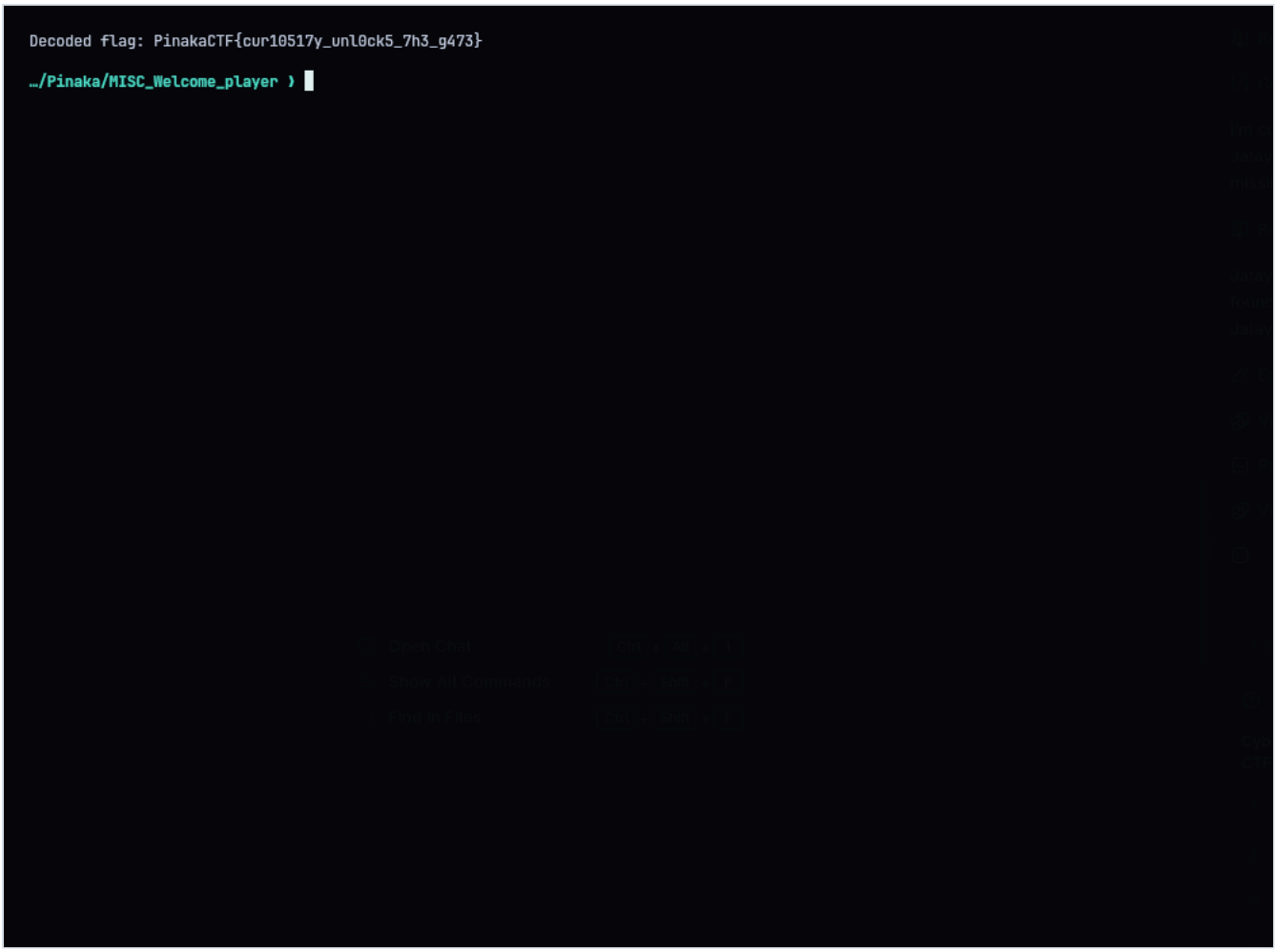
After the third layer, the output is all uppercase letters and 2-7 with `====` padding, which means Base32. `solve.py` does the same four steps:

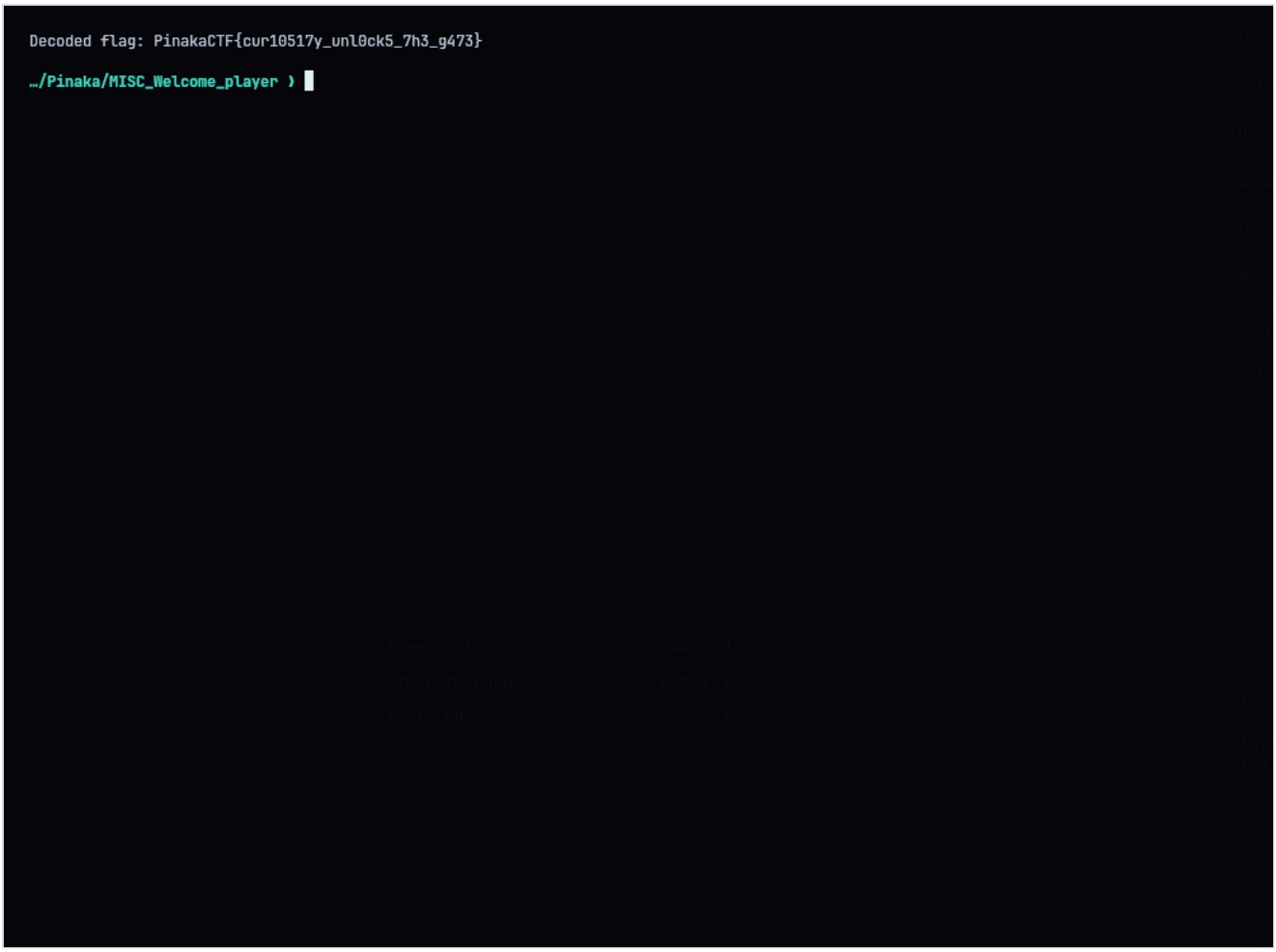
```
python3 solve.py
Decoded flag: PinakaCTF{cur10517y_unl0ck5_7h3_g473}
```


Welcome challenge input token
VXpCS1ZsWjZVbHBVUlhoT1VtdEtWMU5XU2xWTk1ERlBUV3hvUmxSVmNGSlNNVlphVmtVNE1sTjZaRkJXYkdoSVYxVXhSVkp6TlU1TmJGa3lWR3BPU2xJd05WRldNRGxQVVd4b1NGUnFX
…/Pinaka/MISC_Welcome_player ❱


Decoded flag: PinakaCTF{cur10517y_unl0ck5_7h3_g473}
…/Pinaka/MISC_Welcome_player ❯


Base64 layer 1: b'UzBKVlZ6UlpURXhOUmtKV1NWSlVNMDFPTWxoRlRVcFJS'...
Base64 layer 2: b'S0JVVzRZTExNRkJWSVJUM01OMlhFTUpRR1VZVE82SzdP'...
Base64 layer 3: b'KBUW4YLLMFBVIRT3MN2XEMJQGUYTO6K7OVXGYMDDNM2V'...
Base32 layer: b'PinakaCTF{cur10517y_unl0ck5_7h3_g473}'
…/Pinaka/MISC_Welcome_player ❯


Decoded flag: PinakaCTF{cur10517y_unl0ck5_7h3_g473}
…/Pinaka/MISC_Welcome_player ❯


Decoded flag: PinakaCTF{cur10517y_unl0ck5_7h3_g473}
…/Pinaka/MISC_Welcome_player ❯